

CONCEPT NOTE

Scientific Writing Session for the WHO AFRO– Global Fund Supplement

*Documenting Lessons from the Global Fund Strategic Initiative on Sustainable
Human Resources for Health Investments in Africa*

Date: 27 to 31 July 2026

Venue: Kintele

Health Workforce Unit
Health Systems and Services Cluster
WHO Regional Office for Africa
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1. Background and rationale

WHO Regional Office for Africa, with support from the Global Fund, is implementing the Strategic Initiative on “Strengthening health financing and sustainable human resources for health investments in Africa” for the period January 2025–December 2026. The initiative is implemented by the Health Systems and Services Cluster through the Health Finance and Governance unit and the Health Workforce unit.

The initiative supports Member States to generate and use evidence for sustainable health financing and health workforce investment reforms. Under the health financing pillar, WHO AFRO is supporting Health Financing Progress Matrix assessments in Congo, Gabon and Zimbabwe; developing a Budget Impact Analysis guidance and tool for integrating HIV, TB and malaria services into national health benefit packages; and supporting policy dialogue on domestic financing, pooling, purchasing, financial protection and sustainability. Under the health workforce pillar, WHO AFRO is supporting Health Labour Market Analyses in Cameroon, Côte d’Ivoire, Congo, South Sudan and Uganda to inform sustainable health workforce investment, fiscal sustainability, employment absorption, return on investment and implementation of the Africa Health Workforce Investment Charter.

A core deliverable of the grant is a **10-paper peer-reviewed supplement or collection**, proposed for submission to a peer-reviewed journal. It will document methods, results, country experiences, implementation lessons and policy implications from WHO AFRO–Global Fund technical support to Member States.

The proposed scientific writing workshop will accelerate manuscript development, harmonise the analytical framing across papers, improve scientific quality, and ensure timely submission of the supplement within the grant implementation period.

3. Objectives

Overall objective

To support author teams to develop high-quality draft manuscripts for the proposed 10-paper WHO AFRO–Global Fund supplement on health financing and sustainable health workforce investments in Africa.

Specific objectives

1. Define the scope, structure, research questions and policy contribution of each proposed paper.
2. Harmonise analytical frameworks, terminology, methods and reporting standards across the supplement.
3. Develop advanced manuscript drafts, including abstracts, methods, results, discussion and policy implications.

4. Proposed papers

Health workforce papers

1. Health labour market analysis as a tool for sustainable health workforce investment in Africa: regional synthesis from 12 countries.
2. Fiscal sustainability of health workforce investments in Africa: evidence from health labour market analyses.
3. The health workforce employment paradox in Africa: shortages, unemployment and absorption constraints.
4. Returns on investment in health workforce employment: modelling economic and social value of health workforce investments.
5. From evidence to policy dialogue: lessons from using health labour market analysis to shape national health workforce reforms.
6. Assessment of job quality of African health workers: insights from exploratory surveys in 10 countries.
7. How competent are health workers in Africa? A systematic review of diagnostic and treatment accuracy
8. Assessing the productivity of health workers in Zimbabwe
9. Health Workers Absenteeism: A Multi Country Meta-Analysis from exploratory survey in 10 countries
10. The evolution of competency-based education in Africa: A continental review
11. Digital Innovation in African Health Professions Education: A Scoping Review of Emerging Practices

5. Working session format and participants

The working session will be a **5-day intensive scientific writing session** involving **10 writers**. It will combine short technical sessions with protected writing time, manuscript clinics, peer review and editorial feedback.

6. Expected outputs

By the end of the writing session, the following outputs are expected:

1. Ten fully developed manuscripts ready for submission.
2. Draft concept for an overview or editorial paper introducing the supplement.